



T-storms, windy 62/47 • Tomorrow: Partly sunny 51/36 B6

Democracy Dies in Darkness

WEDNESDAY, MARCH 5, 2025 • \$4

Zelensky offers partial ceasefire to restart peace talks

‘Time to make things right’ after Oval Office eruption, halt of U.S. aid

BY SIOBHÁN O’GRADY, LEO SANDS, CATHERINE BELTON AND ELLEN FRANCIS

KYIV — Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky proposed a new framework for a partial ceasefire with Russia on Tuesday, posting on X that Kyiv would be willing to release prisoners and agree to a truce that would ban long-range attacks on civilian and energy infrastructure.

The offer came after the Trump administration declared that Zelensky was not ready for peace and froze the U.S. military assistance that Ukraine has been relying on to battle the Russian invasion.

“Then we want to move very fast through all next stages and to work with the U.S. to agree a strong final deal,” Zelensky wrote, while reiterating his appreciation for U.S. support.

During his joint address to Congress on Tuesday night, President Donald Trump appeared willing to patch things up with Kyiv, saying “I appreciate” Zelensky’s statement. Trump said he received a letter from Zelensky agreeing to come to the negotiating table. “Simultaneously, we’ve had serious discussions with Russia and have received strong signals that they are ready for peace,” he added.

For days Republicans have criticized Zelensky for being not adequately thankful on his trip last week to Washington, where an Oval Office meeting erupted into an argument between him,

SEE UKRAINE ON A11

Unlikely influencer: Post by karate teacher caught Trump’s eye. **A13**



JABIN BOTSFORD/THE WASHINGTON POST

President Donald Trump addresses a joint session of Congress on Tuesday night in the Capitol building’s House chamber in Washington.

Wall Street fears tariffs could wreck economy

Trump’s trade war abroad creates climate of uncertainty at home

BY DAVID J. LYNCH, JEFF STEIN AND EVAN HALPER

Stock markets wobbled Tuesday amid fears that President Donald Trump’s imposition of tariffs on the nation’s three largest trading partners will hobble the world’s largest economy and boost inflation.

All three major U.S. markets sank at the opening bell before regaining lost ground. The Dow Jones Industrial Average, the worst performer, lost more than 1.5 percent and has surrendered almost 1,400 points in the past two days.

Wall Street’s jitters reflect a rapid change in sentiment. After welcoming the president’s promises

of tax cuts, deregulation and a business-friendly White House, investors worry that Trump’s 360-degree trade war is compounding the economic risks of the administration’s self-described revolutionary agenda.

Elon Musk’s efficiency drive has dismantled some parts of the federal government and frozen others. A possible government shutdown looms in 10 days. And the president maintains an ambitious to-do list — including tax legislation, migrant deportations and establishment of a cryptocurrency reserve — that is unsettling many business executives.

Late in the day, the fog of uncertainty enveloping the president’s intentions thickened when Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick

SEE TARIFFS ON A10

Retaliation: China, Mexico and Canada set to launch levies. **A12**

Ready for Trump: In China, the Communist Party gathers. **A14**

Trump touts record to rowdy gallery

BY MATT VISER

President Donald Trump on Tuesday night addressed a divided nation in a speech marked by acrimony, as a Texas Democrat was escorted from the chamber within the first few moments and as Trump taunted Democrats in the room — outlining a message of defiant optimism for those who support him and gloomy despair for those who don’t.

His speech came 43 days after his inauguration, a period marked by turbulent change as he uses his belligerent style to upend global diplomatic norms and trade alliances, deconstruct large portions of the federal government and implement a raft of new policies. It also arrived hours after the stock market tumbled as a result of his newly imposed tariffs, but Trump doubled down on his plans for reciprocal tariffs and made clear that he was unrestrained by any rising Democratic resistance, signs of economic trouble or falsehoods as he made

APPLAUSE, JEERS FOR ACRIMONIOUS SPEECH

‘Just getting started,’ he says of dizzying changes

a number of claims unsupported by the facts.

“It has been nothing but swift and unrelenting action,” he said, in a 100-minute speech that went longer than any presidential address to Congress in recent history. “And we are just getting started.”

“America is back,” he said, adding later, “Our country will be woke no longer.”

Trump arrived in the House chamber for the joint address to Congress with vivid reminders of the control that Republicans now exert over Washington. House Speaker Mike Johnson (Louisiana) sat on one side behind him and Vice President JD Vance on the other.

On their side of the chamber, some Democrats wore pink as a statement for women’s rights and

others dressed in blue and yellow to support Ukraine. And while several prominent members of the party chose to boycott the speech — a reflection of the party’s disapproval of Trump and some of the lingering divisions over how vigorously to oppose him — there were also protests — silent and loud — during the speech.

As Trump walked past her, Rep. Melanie Stansbury (D-New Mexico) held a small handwritten sign that read “This is NOT Normal.” Others held signs aloft as the president spoke, including “Musk Steals” and “Save Medicaid.” Just several minutes into the speech, Rep. Al Green (D-Texas) stood up, shook his cane in the air and shouted at Trump, “You don’t have a mandate!”

Republicans drowned him out

with chants of “USA! USA! USA!” but his protests continued.

“Mr. Green, take your seat. Take your seat, sir,” Johnson said, banging the gavel, before directing the House sergeant at arms to “remove this gentleman from the chamber.”

Even for a president who has often seemed omnipresent since taking office for his second term, the address provided his largest audience since the inauguration. The White House had earlier announced that the theme of the speech would be “The Renewal of the American Dream,” and he touted it as must-see-TV.

He began with an optimistic tone, at times oozing confidence and swagger.

“America’s momentum is back. Our spirit is back, our pride is

SEE SPEECH ON A4

Democrats: Al Green is kicked out as others wield signs and boo. **A4**

BLM Plaza’s future: Mayor backs new mural after Republican bill. **B1**

Major federal buildings in D.C. area on list to be sold

BY AARON WIENER, JOE HEIM AND RACHEL WEINER

The Trump administration on Tuesday announced that hundreds of federally owned properties are available for sale, including the headquarters of the Justice Department, Labor Department and U.S. Census Bureau — an effort that, if carried out, could radically shrink the federal real estate portfolio and have a major impact on the D.C. area.

The General Services Administration, the government’s real estate arm, released a list of 443 office properties deemed “not core to government operations,” as part of its effort to dramatically reduce the size of the federal government. The announcement, made hours before President Donald Trump was scheduled to address a joint session of Congress, says the spaces

SEE PROPERTIES ON A2



MARTIN BERNETTI/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Hong Kong company to sell stake in Panama Canal ports

A ship waits to enter the Panama Canal on Feb. 23. A Hong Kong-based firm said Tuesday it would sell to a U.S.-led consortium its control of a company that owns and operates two ports on the canal, seemingly in response to President Donald Trump’s threats over what he called Chinese influence. **Story, A12**

Pentagon moves to halt civilian protection work

Effort to limit collateral damage from military strikes on chopping block

BY ALEX HORTON, MEG KELLY AND DAN LAMOTHE

The Defense Department is moving to dismantle efforts focused on reducing civilian harm in U.S. military operations, according to three defense officials, part of a Trump administration shift to scale back protections of innocents so commanders can focus more on “lethality” when conducting military strikes.

Pentagon leaders have decided to shutter civilian protection efforts across the agency, according to two of the officials. On the chopping block is a broad cross-command effort known as the Civilian Harm Mitigation and Response, which includes dozens of staffers worldwide who work

alongside commanders to refine targeting operations, along with a center overseen by the Army that outlines best practices and training for military leaders to follow.

The engine of the effort, the Civilian Protection Center of Excellence, or CP CoE, was a target before President Donald Trump took office, with a Day 1 order for officials to submit plans for its “disestablishment.”

Though its formal closure requires congressional approval, staffers at the center have expressed concerns that Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth will effectively gut the organization, said people familiar with the matter, who like some others spoke on the condition of anonymity because of the sensitivity of the issue.

The center’s senior leadership was instructed Monday that the Pentagon was moving forward with plans to halt all civilian harm mitigation work, including

SEE PENTAGON ON A6

Yemen’s Houthis: U.S. labels group a terrorist organization. **A6**

IN THE NEWS

Measuring the economy The Trump administration proposed a new way of calculating GDP that strips out government spending amid negative forecasts. **A16**

Officers reinstated Two men pardoned in a fatal police pursuit in D.C. in 2020 were permitted to return to full duty. **B1**

THE NATION The health secretary’s focus on vitamin A use to combat measles has worried health experts. **A3**
The Supreme Court struck down EPA rules on the discharge of water pollution. **A5**

THE WORLD Palestinians began Ramadan over the weekend amid fears over what comes next in the war. **A8**
At an emergency summit, Arab leaders adopted a unified plan for the future of Gaza. **A9**

THE ECONOMY Amazon lost a fight to avoid a permitting process for diesel generators at a proposed data center northwest of Minneapolis. **A15**
The Justice Department is poised to drop a lawsuit against a Louisiana petrochemical plant, two people said. **A16**

THE REGION A trans McDonald’s worker who was fired after reporting discrimination won nearly \$1 million in damages and is now helping others. **B1**
Amid budget negotiations, Maryland lawmakers are seeking to raise \$1 billion through a new business tax. **B1**

STYLE Mason Pearson hairbrushes may have a hair-raising price, but some Gen Z influencers adore them. **C1**
FOOD Dispirited by baking fails? Addressing these four common problems could help you get back on a roll. **E1**

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